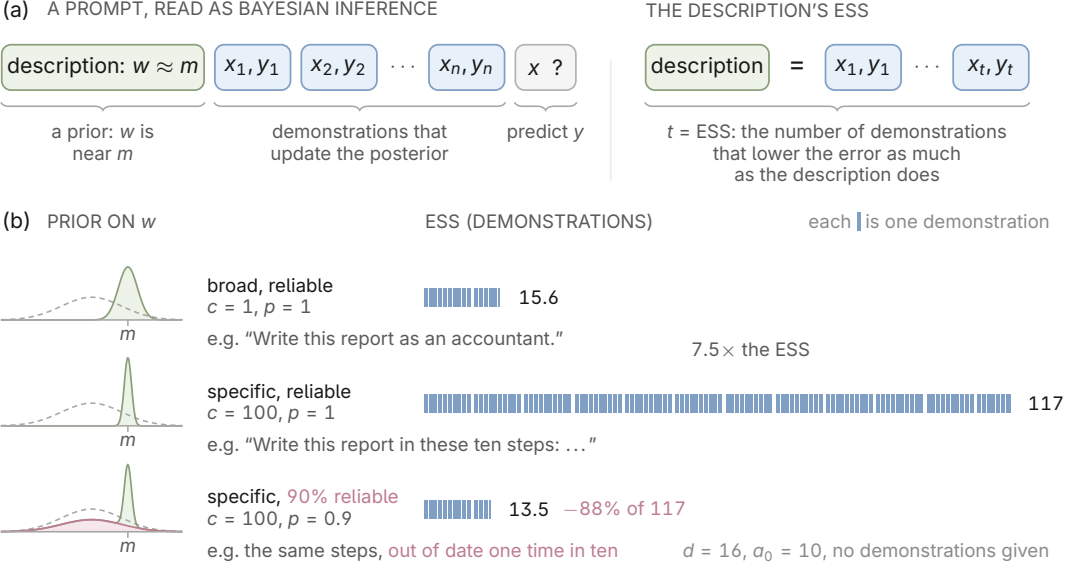

(a) A PROMPT, READ AS BAYESIAN INFERENCE
description: $w \approx m$
x_1, y_1
x_2, y_2
$\cdots$
x_n, y_n
x ?
a prior: w is near m
demonstrations that update the posterior
predict y
THE DESCRIPTION'S ESS
description
=
x_1, y_1
$\cdots$
x_t, y_t
t = ESS: the number of demonstrations that lower the error as much as the description does
(b) PRIOR ON w
ESS (DEMONSTRATIONS)
each ▮ is one demonstration
m
broad, reliable
$c = 1, p = 1$
15.6
e.g. "Write this report as an accountant."
7.5× the ESS
m
specific, reliable
$c = 100, p = 1$
117
e.g. "Write this report in these ten steps: …"
m
specific, 90% reliable
$c = 100, p = 0.9$
13.5
−88% of 117
e.g. the same steps, out of date one time in ten
$d = 16, a_0 = 10$, no demonstrations given